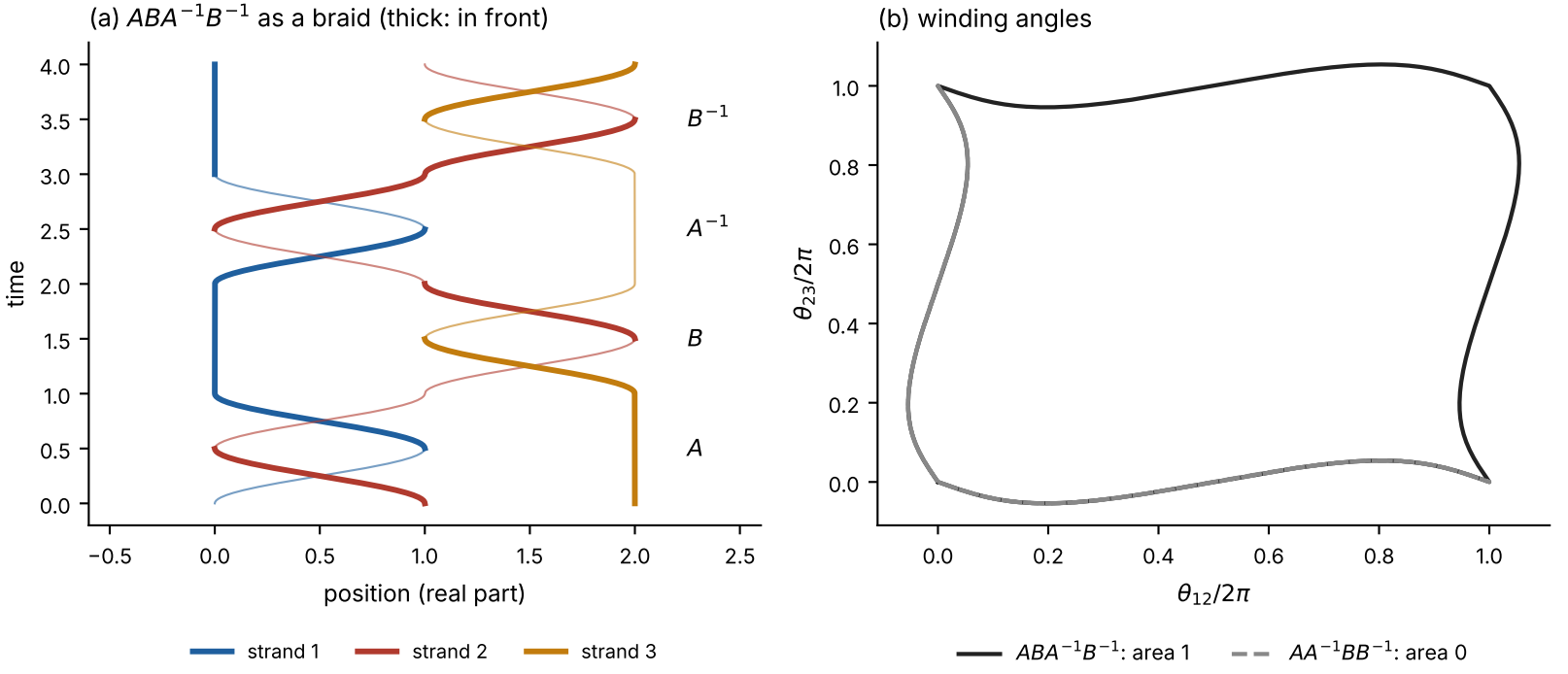
(a) $ABA^{-1}B^{-1}$ as a braid (thick: in front)
time
position (real part)
B^{-1}
A^{-1}
B
A
strand 1
strand 2
strand 3
(b) winding angles
$\theta_{23}/2\pi$
$\theta_{12}/2\pi$
$ABA^{-1}B^{-1}$: area 1
$AA^{-1}BB^{-1}$: area 0